Problem Framing & Prioritization

Increasing AOV at Zepto

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Zepto: Increasing AOV

User Research, Segmentation, Problem Framing, Solutions and Prioritization

Objective

The task is to take on the role of a Product Manager at Zepto and develop a strategy to increase Average Order Value (AOV), which is also referred to as basket size or cart value.

Average Order Value is the average amount a customer spends each time they place an order. Increasing AOV means encouraging users to add more items to their cart before they check out. This is one of the most effective ways for a quick commerce platform like Zepto to grow revenue without needing to acquire new customers.

To achieve this, the document follows a structured product thinking approach covering the following steps in order:

- Understanding who the users are and how they shop — User Segmentation
- Identifying what stops them from spending more — Key Blockers
- Framing the core problem clearly — Problem Statement
- Proposing targeted solutions to fix the problem — Solutions
- Deciding which solutions to build first and why — Prioritization using the RICE Framework
- A final summary of everything — Closing Summary

1. Research Methodology

Good product decisions are built on good research. Before proposing any solution, it is important to understand how this research was conducted, what sources were used, and how confident we can be in the findings. This section explains exactly that.

This research combines both primary research — where data was collected directly from real users — and secondary research — where existing published information was studied and analysed.

1.1 Primary Research — Survey Conducted Directly with Zepto Users

A structured survey was designed and conducted specifically for this assignment. The purpose of the survey was to go beyond general observations and collect real, first-hand data on how Zepto users actually behave, what motivates them, and what stops them from placing larger orders.

Survey Details:

- Platform used: SurveyMars
- Total respondents: 23 Zepto users
- Total questions: 13, covering age, occupation, shopping behavior, basket size, blockers, product discovery, offer preferences, and open-ended feedback
- Question types: Multiple choice, rating scale (1 to 5), rank order, matrix rating, and open-ended text
- Respondent profile: 69.57% working professionals, 21.74% homemakers, 4.35% students — aged primarily between 25 and 44 years

Why this matters: The survey gives us data that goes beyond assumptions. Instead of guessing why users do not add more items, we now have direct answers from real users. These answers are used throughout this document — especially in the blockers section and the RICE Prioritization — to back up every observation with real evidence.

1.2 Secondary Research — Published Sources and Industry Data

In addition to the primary survey, the following secondary sources were studied to provide a broader understanding of user behavior and market context:

- App store reviews and user feedback from Google Play Store and Apple App Store for Zepto
- Published consumer behavior studies on quick commerce and grocery delivery in India
- Competitor analysis of Blinkit, Swiggy Instamart, and BigBasket to understand common pain points across the industry

- Online community discussions on Reddit and Twitter/X where users openly share their Zepto experiences
- Industry data on AOV benchmarks and order conversion patterns in Indian quick commerce

Together, the primary survey and secondary research give a well-rounded and reliable picture of Zepto user behavior. Where the survey data and secondary research align, the finding can be considered strongly validated. Where only one source supports a finding, it is noted accordingly.

1.3 Primary Research: Survey Findings and What They Tell Us

This section presents the key findings from the survey conducted as part of this research. Each finding is explained in plain and simple terms. For every finding, we explain both what the data shows (the behavior) and why it matters (the reason behind the behavior and its impact on AOV). This ensures a complete and balanced understanding of the user.

Finding 1: Most Users Shop on Zepto Out of Urgency, Not for Planned Grocery Runs

What the data shows:

78.26% of respondents said their primary reason for using Zepto is to get items delivered urgently for immediate use. Only 17.39% said they use it for the convenience of getting all grocery needs in one order. Just 4.35% said they enjoy browsing new products.

Why this happens:

Zepto has built its brand and reputation on speed — 10-minute delivery. This has trained users to think of Zepto as an emergency solution rather than a planned shopping destination. When users associate the app with urgency, they open it with a very specific item in mind, find it quickly, and leave. The speed that makes Zepto unique is also the reason users do not stay and browse. There is no mental space for exploration when you are in a hurry.

Survey Data: *78.26% of respondents said they primarily use Zepto for urgent delivery of items needed immediately.*

Finding 2: The Typical Zepto Order Contains Very Few Items

What the data shows:

52.17% of respondents typically buy 3 to 5 items per order. 34.78% buy only 1 to 2 items. This means 87% of users place orders of 5 items or fewer. Only 8.7% buy 6 to 10 items and just 4.35% place large grocery orders of 11 or more items.

Why this happens:

When a user opens the app for one specific item — say a packet of milk — their attention is completely focused on finding and buying that item. They do not browse other sections because they did not come here to browse. The app experience itself also does not create enough moments of discovery that feel relevant to what they are already buying. Without a pull to explore, users follow the shortest path to checkout.

Survey Data: *87% of respondents buy 5 items or fewer in a typical Zepto order. Only 13% place larger restock or grocery orders.*

Finding 3: Delivery Charges Are the Biggest Reason Users Stop Adding Items

What the data shows:

Respondents were asked to rank five factors that stop them from adding more items. Not wanting to pay extra delivery charges ranked first with a composite score of 3.74 out of 5. 43.48% placed it at the very top of their list.

Why this happens:

When a user's total order value is small — say INR 80 to INR 150 — delivery and handling charges can add 15% to 25% on top. This makes the total feel disproportionate to what the user is getting. The user starts to do a mental calculation: is it worth adding one more item just to avoid the fee? Often, the answer is no — especially if they do not urgently need that extra item. The delivery fee creates a psychological barrier that makes any addition feel like a cost, not a benefit.

Survey Data: *Delivery charges ranked #1 blocker with composite score 3.74. 43.48% of users ranked it as their top reason for not adding more items.*

Finding 4: Users Stop Adding Items as Soon as They Hit the Free Delivery Minimum

What the data shows:

39.13% Strongly Agreed and 17.39% Agreed that they stop adding items once they reach the free delivery minimum. Combined, 56.52% of users exhibit this behavior. The average rating was 3.52 out of 5.

Why this happens:

The free delivery minimum works as a goal for users — they add items until they reach it, and then they stop because the goal has been achieved. There is no new goal waiting for them above that point. In the absence of any reward or incentive for spending beyond the free delivery

threshold, users have no reason to keep shopping. The threshold becomes a hard stop rather than a stepping stone to a larger basket.

Survey Data: *56.52% of users agree they stop adding items once free delivery is unlocked. Average score: 3.52 out of 5.*

Finding 5: Users Are Willing to Add Future-Needed Items to Reach the Threshold

What the data shows:

When asked what they would do to reach the free delivery minimum, 47.83% said they would add an item they will need in the near future anyway. Only 26.09% said they would add a cheaper item they do not really need, and 13.04% would simply pay the delivery charge.

Why this happens:

Users are not opposed to spending more — they are opposed to spending more on things they do not need. When a user can see a product that is genuinely useful to them, they are happy to add it. This tells us that the issue is not user reluctance to spend — it is the absence of the right product suggestion at the right moment. If Zepto shows relevant items that the user was likely to buy anyway, they will add them without hesitation.

Survey Data: *47.83% would add a future-needed item to reach the free delivery threshold — a positive and natural shopping behavior.*

Finding 6: Personalized Recommendations Have Not Yet Earned Full Trust

What the data shows:

56.52% of respondents were neutral about trusting Zepto's personalised product recommendations. Only 13.04% agreed and 21.74% strongly agreed that they trust them. 8.7% strongly disagreed. The average trust score was 3.39 out of 5.

Why this happens:

Neutral trust usually means the recommendations exist but are not yet accurate enough to feel genuinely personalised. When a user who always buys full-cream milk is shown a recommendation for a product they would never buy, it signals that the system does not really know them. Over time, irrelevant recommendations teach users to ignore the section entirely. Trust is built through repeated relevance — every time a recommendation feels spot-on, trust grows a little. Every time it feels random, trust erodes.

Survey Data: *56.52% of users are neutral about trusting Zepto's personalised recommendations. Average trust score: 3.39 out of 5.*

Finding 7: Users Discover New Products Mainly Through the Homepage and Category Pages

What the data shows:

The top product discovery channels were: homepage personalised recommendations (43.48%), category pages when browsing (43.48%), bundle offers with items already in cart (39.13%), and discount banners on the homepage (39.13%). Social media was the weakest channel at just 13.04%.

Why this happens:

Users who open the app for a specific item naturally end up on the homepage first and then navigate to the relevant category. These are the two surfaces they are already looking at — so any product placed here has the best chance of being noticed. Bundle offers also perform well because they appear at the moment when the user already has items in their cart and is close to checking out — a moment when adding one more relevant item feels natural.

Survey Data: *Homepage and category pages are the top discovery channels, each selected by 43.48% of respondents.*

Finding 8: Extra Discounts for Higher Order Value Are the Most Motivating Offer

What the data shows:

Extra percentage discount for increasing order value above the current total scored the highest average of 3.52 out of 5. Bundle discounts scored 3.35, free gifts scored 3.35, buy one get one free offers scored 3.22, and personalised coupons for new categories scored 3.00.

Why this happens:

A percentage discount for spending more is easy to understand and immediately feels rewarding. The user can see the exact benefit — spend INR 200 more and save INR 40 — and the math is simple. Other offer types require more effort to understand or feel less directly connected to what the user is spending. The clearer and more direct the reward, the more likely users are to act on it.

Survey Data: *Percentage-based discounts for higher order values scored the highest at 3.52 — the most effective offer type to encourage larger baskets.*

Finding 9: Most Users Rarely Explore Categories They Do Not Usually Buy From

What the data shows:

30.43% explore new categories occasionally — once a month. 26.09% explore frequently — once a week. But 17.39% never explore new categories at all, and 13.04% do so only rarely. Only 13.04% said they always love trying new categories.

Why this happens:

Users develop a mental map of what Zepto is good for based on their own experience. If a user has only ever ordered packaged snacks and beverages, they naturally assume that is what Zepto is best at. They do not explore beyond that because they have no reason to believe Zepto would serve their fresh produce needs well. This mental boundary is rarely challenged unless something — a recommendation, a deal, or a visible quality signal — makes the user consider stepping outside their comfort zone.

Survey Data: *17.39% of users never explore new categories. 30.43% explore occasionally — once a month.*

Finding 10: Impulse Additions Happen but Are Not Yet Consistent

What the data shows:

21.74% strongly agreed and 21.74% agreed that they often add unplanned items on impulse — a combined 43.48%. However, 26.09% were neutral and 17.39% disagreed. The average score was 3.22 out of 5.

Why this happens:

Impulse additions happen when a user sees something at the right moment that feels relevant, affordable, and easy to add. The conditions for impulse buying exist in about half the user base but are not being consistently triggered. This means the opportunity is there — the users are open to it — but the platform is not yet presenting the right products at the right moments to make impulse additions a regular occurrence.

Survey Data: *43.48% of users say they sometimes add unplanned items on impulse. Average score: 3.22 out of 5.*

Finding 11: Users Want Genuine Help, Not Manipulation

What the data shows:

Open-ended responses from users produced a word cloud that prominently showed the phrases avoid dark patterns, add products, and good. This tells us that users are aware of manipulative design tactics and actively dislike them.

Why this happens:

Users today are savvy. They have experienced fake countdown timers, misleading discounts, and forced bundle purchases on various apps. When these tactics appear on Zepto, they create distrust rather than purchases. Users want to feel that the app is on their side — helping them find value — not trying to squeeze more money out of them. When the experience feels honest, users are more willing to engage with recommendations and offers.

Survey Feedback: *Users explicitly asked Zepto to avoid dark patterns. They want helpful product suggestions, not pressure tactics.*

2: User Segmentation Based on Shopping Behavior

Understanding who Zepto's users are is the first step in identifying why their basket sizes are small and what can be done about it. Based on the primary survey and secondary research, Zepto customers can be divided into two broad groups: Regular Ordering Users and Occasional Ordering Users. Within each group, users have different shopping patterns, basket sizes, motivations, and blockers.

2.1 Quick Reference: Segment Overview

Segment	Shopping Pattern	Basket Size (INR)	Primary Expectation
Families	Weekly/bi-weekly grocery runs	INR 800 - 1,500	One-stop household solution
Bachelors	Daily essentials, small qty	INR 150 - 350	Quick and convenient
Working Professionals (Regular)	Groceries + ready-to-eat	INR 400 - 700	Time-saving experience
Students / Hostellers	Snacks, beverages, budget items	INR 100 - 250	Affordable with offers
Working Professionals (Occasional)	Emergency or urgent purchases	INR 100 - 300	Fast delivery
Individual Users	Specific product purchases	INR 100 - 200	Product availability

Note: *Basket size value are estimated*

A. Regular Ordering Users

These users order frequently from Zepto and rely on the platform as part of their daily or weekly routine.

1. Families

What they do (Behavior):

Families place weekly or bi-weekly grocery orders across multiple categories. They buy household essentials, groceries, snacks, fruits, vegetables, and dairy products in a single order.

Why they do it (Motivation):

Families have a household to manage and a recurring set of needs. They want one reliable platform where they can tick off everything on their list without visiting multiple stores. Time is valuable — both parents may be working, and making multiple trips to buy groceries is not practical.

Current Basket Size:

Medium to High — approximately INR 800 to INR 1,500 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- Planned weekly grocery runs
- Mid-week top-up when a specific essential runs out
- Festival or occasion-based stocking up

AOV Opportunity:

Families are already placing larger orders. The opportunity is to encourage them to expand into categories they currently avoid on Zepto — especially fresh produce — by building trust in quality and freshness.

2. Bachelors / Individuals

What they do (Behavior):

Bachelors make frequent purchases of daily essentials in small quantities. They typically buy 1 to 3 items at a time and value speed over price.

Why they do it (Motivation):

Living alone means needs arise unpredictably. A bachelor does not plan a weekly grocery run — they buy what they need when they need it. Zepto's 10-minute delivery fits perfectly into this lifestyle. However, because purchases are unplanned and urgent, there is little reason to add anything extra.

Current Basket Size:

Low to Medium — approximately INR 150 to INR 350 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- Late-night cravings or snack runs
- Emergency top-up for a missing ingredient
- Daily essentials like milk, eggs, or bread

AOV Opportunity:

Lowering the free delivery threshold and showing relevant bundle suggestions can encourage bachelors to add 1 to 2 more items per order.

3. Working Professionals

What they do (Behavior):

Working professionals order groceries, snacks, beverages, and ready-to-eat products. They prefer the convenience of delivery over visiting a store.

Why they do it (Motivation):

Long working hours leave little time for shopping. Zepto allows them to restock essentials during a lunch break or after work without stepping outside. However, since they are time-pressed, they also tend to stick to their known list and exit quickly.

Current Basket Size:

Medium — approximately INR 400 to INR 700 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- Post-work grocery orders
- Lunchtime top-ups or snack restocking
- Weekend meal prep purchases

AOV Opportunity:

Time-saving bundle deals and smart stock alerts for their regular items would encourage working professionals to place fuller orders in fewer sessions.

B. Occasional Ordering Users

These users do not rely on Zepto regularly. They open the app only when a specific need arises.

1. Students / Hostellers

What they do (Behavior):

Students make budget-conscious purchases of snacks, beverages, instant foods, and daily essentials.

Why they do it (Motivation):

Students have limited monthly budgets and are very price-sensitive. They use Zepto for convenience — especially late at night or during exam season — but every purchase is weighed against cost. They are not loyal to any platform and will switch to whichever one offers the best deal.

Current Basket Size:

Low — approximately INR 100 to INR 250 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- Hostel room snack stocking
- Late-night group orders with friends
- Buying instant noodles or beverages during study hours

AOV Opportunity:

Group-friendly bundle deals and visible daily offers can encourage students to add more items per order, especially when sharing an order with hostel mates.

2. Working Professionals (Occasional Users)

What they do (Behavior):

These users open Zepto only during emergencies or when a specific urgent need arises. They typically purchase only 1 to 2 items.

Why they do it (Motivation):

They do not think of Zepto as a regular shopping destination. It is their backup option — used when a local store is closed or when time is extremely tight. Because they use the app infrequently, they have not developed a shopping routine on the platform.

Current Basket Size:

Low — approximately INR 100 to INR 300 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- Emergency purchase of medicines or a forgotten ingredient
- Last-minute ordering before guests arrive

AOV Opportunity:

Re-engagement offers and stock alerts for their urgent items can bring these users back more regularly and encourage larger orders over time.

3. Individual Users

What they do (Behavior):

These users open Zepto only for a specific product that they cannot easily find elsewhere or need immediately.

Why they do it (Motivation):

They are not regular grocery shoppers on any app. They use Zepto as a convenience tool for a one-off purchase. Because they have no ongoing relationship with the platform, there is no habit of browsing or exploring.

Current Basket Size:

Low — approximately INR 100 to INR 200 per order.

Shopping Occasion:

- One-off purchases of a niche or hard-to-find product
- Comparing prices before buying elsewhere

AOV Opportunity:

Relevant you might also need suggestions on the product page can nudge these users to add a complementary item before checking out.

C. Additional Behavioral Segments Observed

Beyond demographic segments, users also fall into behavioral patterns that cut across age groups and lifestyles. These patterns directly influence how large or small a basket tends to be. The survey confirmed several of these patterns with real data.

1. Convenience Shoppers

What they do:

Order only 1 to 3 items urgently.

Why they do it:

Speed is the only priority. They opened the app because something ran out and they need it now. Browsing feels like a waste of time.

Survey Confirmation: *78.26% of respondents said they shop primarily for urgent delivery — confirming this is the dominant behavior on Zepto.*

2. Weekly Stock-Up Shoppers

What they do:

Purchase groceries for several days at once, typically over the weekend.

Why they do it:

They prefer to plan ahead and reduce the number of times they need to shop. A larger single order saves time across the week.

Survey Confirmation: *Only 8.7% of respondents place 6 to 10 item orders for weekly restocking — showing this segment is currently underserved and a clear growth opportunity.*

3. Deal Seekers

What they do:

Order mainly when discounts or offers are available.

Why they do it:

Value for money is the primary driver. They will add more items when they feel they are getting a good deal, but will not add anything at full price that they were not already planning to buy.

Survey Confirmation: *Extra percentage discounts for higher order values scored highest among all offer types at 3.52 — deal seekers respond strongly to value-based incentives.*

4. Premium Shoppers

What they do:

Focus on quality and convenience rather than price. They explore multiple categories.

Why they do it:

They are willing to pay more if the product quality and delivery experience are reliable. They are already open to spending more — they just need to trust the platform.

Survey Confirmation: *26.09% of users explore new categories frequently — once a week — suggesting an active premium and exploratory segment exists on the platform.*

3. Key Blockers Preventing Higher Basket Size

This section explains the specific reasons why users do not add more items to their Zepto cart. For each blocker, we explain what behavior we observe, why that behavior happens, and what impact it has on AOV. Where the survey provides direct evidence, it is highlighted clearly. This ensures every blocker is grounded in both user behavior and the reasoning behind it.

Blocker 1: High Product Prices

What we observe:

Some users feel that product prices on Zepto are noticeably higher than what they would pay at a nearby store or competing app.

Why this happens:

Quick commerce platforms carry operational costs — dark stores, last-mile delivery, packaging — that traditional stores do not. These costs sometimes result in slightly higher prices. Users who are aware of this difference start to mentally separate Zepto into must-have urgent purchases versus nice-to-have browsing purchases. The higher price prevents them from doing the latter.

Impact on AOV:

- Users restrict purchases to essential items only
- Reduces willingness to explore or try products in new categories

Blocker 2: Product Unavailability (Out of Stock)

What we observe:

Users often cannot find the specific products they came to buy, which is one of the most frustrating experiences reported.

Why this happens:

Inventory management in quick commerce is complex. Dark stores hold a finite amount of stock and demand can be unpredictable. When a user repeatedly finds their regular item out of stock, they lose confidence in the platform and start placing smaller, cautious orders — only buying what they are sure will be available.

Impact on AOV:

- Users reduce their order size or abandon the cart entirely
- Trust in the platform decreases over time, reducing return visits and basket sizes

Blocker 3: Limited Product Requirement

What we observe:

Many users open the app to buy only 1 or 2 specific items and have no intention of buying more.

Why this happens:

The urgency-first positioning of Zepto means users arrive with a task in mind, not a browsing mindset. Once the task is complete, there is no natural reason to stay.

Survey Evidence: *87% of respondents buy 5 items or fewer per order. 34.78% buy only 1 to 2 items.*

Impact on AOV:

- Naturally results in smaller baskets
- Users complete checkout immediately after finding the required product

Blocker 4: Delivery, Handling, and Surge Fees

What we observe:

Additional charges on top of the product price make users more cautious and less willing to add extra items.

Why this happens:

When delivery and handling fees are added, the effective price of each item in the cart increases. A user ordering INR 100 worth of goods who is charged INR 25 in fees is effectively paying 25% extra. This makes every potential addition feel like it costs more than its listed price. The math discourages exploration.

Survey Evidence: *Delivery charges ranked #1 blocker with composite score 3.74. 43.48% of respondents placed it at the top of their list.*

Impact on AOV:

- Users avoid adding items they consider non-essential
- Some users postpone or cancel purchases altogether when fees feel disproportionate

Blocker 5: Trust Restricted to Certain Categories

What we observe:

Users trust Zepto for packaged and branded goods but hesitate to order fresh produce, meat, or vegetables.

Why this happens:

Fresh products carry quality risk that packaged goods do not. A biscuit from Zepto is identical to a biscuit from a store. But a tomato from Zepto might be bruised, overripe, or wilted. Even one bad experience with a fresh product creates a lasting negative association. Users decide it is safer and more reliable to buy fresh items from a local vendor they can see and touch.

Examples:

- Ordering milk but not vegetables
- Ordering snacks but not fresh produce
- Ordering packaged goods but not meat or fruits

Survey Evidence: *17.39% of users never explore new categories on Zepto. Category trust was identified as one of the top blockers in the research.*

Impact on AOV:

- Limits category exploration and keeps the basket narrow
- Large portions of the product catalogue remain unused by most customers

Blocker 6: Lack of Strong Incentives to Add More Products

What we observe:

After finding the required product, users see no compelling reason to continue browsing or adding more items.

Why this happens:

The free delivery minimum is the only current milestone in the shopping journey. Once reached, there is no next goal. Without a reward waiting above the threshold, users have completed their objective and the rational thing to do is check out.

Survey Evidence: *56.52% of users stop adding items as soon as the free delivery minimum is reached. Average score: 3.52 out of 5.*

Impact on AOV:

- Checkout happens quickly once the free delivery goal is met
- Missed opportunity to cross-sell and upsell above the threshold

Blocker 7: Poor Product Discovery

What we observe:

Users may not discover related or complementary products during their shopping journey because the platform does not surface relevant suggestions at the right moment.

Why this happens:

If the recommendation engine is not personalised enough, users see suggestions that feel generic and irrelevant. When that happens repeatedly, users learn to ignore the recommendation section entirely. What should be the most powerful tool for increasing AOV becomes invisible.

Examples:

- Buying bread but not seeing butter or jam recommendations
- Buying noodles but not seeing sauces or snacks

Survey Evidence: *43.48% discover products via homepage and category pages. Bundle offers were selected by 39.13%, showing users respond well to complementary suggestions when placed correctly.*

Impact on AOV:

- Reduced chances of adding additional products to the cart

Blocker 8: Budget Constraints

What we observe:

Students, bachelors, and some working professionals actively manage their spending and consciously keep their cart values low.

Why this happens:

For price-sensitive users, every rupee spent on Zepto is a rupee not spent on something else. They are not impulsive buyers — they are careful and deliberate. Even if they want to add something, they remove it before checkout if it pushes the total beyond their mental budget.

Survey Evidence: *Do not want to spend more money ranked 4th as a blocker with composite score 2.83.*

Impact on AOV:

- Users intentionally limit cart value
- Limits basket expansion in price-sensitive segments

Blocker 9: Free Delivery Threshold Acts as a Ceiling

What we observe:

Users feel the minimum order value for free delivery is hard to reach with only the items they need. But once they do reach it, they stop immediately.

Why this happens:

The threshold has upward pull — it motivates users to add items on the way up. But once the goal is achieved, that pull disappears completely. There is nothing above the threshold to keep users shopping. The survey also showed that 47.83% of users would willingly add a future-needed item to reach the threshold — confirming that the pull exists, but only until the goal is met.

Survey Evidence: *56.52% stop adding items once free delivery is reached. 47.83% would add a future-needed item to hit the threshold — showing pull on the way up, and a hard stop at the top.*

Impact on AOV:

- The threshold functions as a ceiling, not a floor
- Can lead to cart abandonment if the threshold feels too far away

Blocker 10: Fragmented Shopping Habits

What we observe:

Users buy different categories from different sources — some from Zepto, some from local vendors, some from other apps.

Why this happens:

Users have developed shopping habits over years. They trust their local vegetable vendor for fresh produce, their kirana store for certain brands, and Zepto for packaged goods. These habits are sticky and hard to change without a strong reason.

Examples:

- Groceries from Zepto
- Vegetables from local vendors
- Meat from specialty stores

Impact on AOV:

- Basket size remains limited to a narrow set of categories

Blocker 11: Urgency-Driven Purchases

What we observe:

Many Zepto orders are triggered by a single immediate need. Users focus entirely on that one item and show no interest in browsing further.

Why this happens:

Urgency creates tunnel vision. When a user needs milk before their morning chai and opens Zepto at 7 AM, their entire mental energy is directed at finding that one item. They are not in a shopping mood — they are in a problem-solving mode. In that state, any attempt to show them other products feels like an interruption, not an opportunity.

Survey Evidence: *78.26% said they primarily use Zepto for urgent delivery. Being in a hurry ranked 5th as a blocker with composite score 2.35.*

Impact on AOV:

- Users focus only on the urgent item and exit quickly

Blocker 12: App Experience and UI Friction

What we observe:

Some users abandon their cart or stop browsing due to a frustrating in-app experience — poor search results, slow loading, cluttered layout, or a checkout process that feels unnecessarily long.

Why this happens:

When an app is slow or confusing, users lose patience quickly. In quick commerce especially, speed is the whole value proposition. If the app itself is slow or hard to navigate, it contradicts the very reason the user chose the platform. Users exit and do not come back for exploratory purchases.

Examples:

- Search returning irrelevant results for common products
- Categories not surfacing the right products quickly
- Slow load times reducing the motivation to keep browsing

Survey Feedback: *Users explicitly asked Zepto to avoid dark patterns — signaling that confusing or manipulative UX creates distrust.*

Impact on AOV:

- Users exit before completing or expanding their order
- Poor experience reduces the likelihood of returning for larger purchases

Summary of Key Blockers — Ranked by Survey Evidence

Blocker	Survey-Backed Priority	Why It Matters Most
Delivery charges on small orders	HIGHEST — Composite score 3.74, ranked #1 by 43.48%	The single biggest reason users do not add more items
Free delivery threshold acts as a ceiling	HIGH — 56.52% stop adding items once threshold is reached	No motivation to spend beyond the free delivery point
Urgency-driven, small-item orders	HIGH — 78.26% shop urgently; 87% buy 5 items or fewer	Users are not in a browsing or discovery mindset
Poor product discovery and weak recommendations	MEDIUM-HIGH — 56.52% neutral on trusting recommendations	Users miss relevant products they would otherwise add
Limited trust in new categories	MEDIUM — 17.39% never explore new categories	Users stick to familiar categories, limiting basket width
Lack of incentives above the free delivery threshold	MEDIUM — Tiered discounts scored 3.52 in offer preference	No reward exists to push users past the free delivery point
App experience and UI friction	MEDIUM — Users flagged dark patterns in open feedback	Confusing UX causes drop-off before checkout is complete

4. Problem Framing

4.1 Key Problem Statement

Zepto users primarily use the platform to fulfil urgent, immediate needs, which naturally results in small basket sizes. The survey confirms that 78.26% of users shop for urgent delivery and 87% place orders of 5 items or fewer.

Beyond this urgency-driven behavior, users face several barriers that prevent them from adding more items to their cart. Delivery charges on small orders are the single biggest blocker, ranked number one by 43.48% of survey respondents. Out-of-stock products, perceived high pricing, and additional handling or surge fees further discourage users from exploring beyond their intended purchase.

Users also tend to stop adding items as soon as they reach the free delivery minimum, with 56.52% confirming this behavior — meaning the threshold acts as a ceiling rather than a motivator to spend more. Limited trust in categories outside their usual purchases — particularly fresh produce and meat — and poor discovery of relevant or complementary products further restrict basket growth.

Together, these factors prevent users from exploring additional products, reduce cross-sell and upsell opportunities, and ultimately limit Average Order Value (AOV) growth for Zepto.

5. Proposed Solutions to Increase AOV

Based on the user segments, blockers, and problem statement identified above, five targeted solutions are proposed. Each solution is explained with the behavior it addresses, the reason behind that behavior, how the solution works, who benefits, and the expected impact on AOV.

5.1 Quick Overview of All Solutions

Solution	Problem It Solves	Who Benefits Most	Expected Impact on AOV
Price Drops and Competitive Pricing	High product prices reducing willingness to explore	All segments, especially students and bachelors	Users explore more and add more when prices feel fair
Stock Availability Alerts for Repeat Orders	Out-of-stock frustration and loss of trust	Families and working professionals	Users place fuller, more confident orders
Daily Deals, Festive and Weekend Offers	No incentive to add more beyond immediate need	Deal seekers, students, price-conscious users	Promotions trigger larger baskets and category exploration
Lower Minimum Order Value for Free Delivery	Delivery and handling fees discouraging purchases	Bachelors, students, occasional users	Fewer abandoned carts, more items added to hit threshold
Product Quality and Freshness Standards	Limited trust in fresh categories	Families and homemakers buying fresh produce	Trust growth leads to wider category adoption

Solution 1: Price Drops and Competitive Pricing

What behavior are we addressing?

Users — especially students, bachelors, and budget-conscious shoppers — hesitate to add extra items to their cart because the product prices on Zepto feel high compared to local stores or competing apps.

Why does this behavior happen?

Quick commerce platforms carry operational costs such as dark stores, packaging, and last-mile delivery that traditional stores do not. These costs can result in slightly higher product prices. When users notice this difference, they mentally classify Zepto as a platform only for urgent, essential purchases. They do not feel comfortable exploring or adding extra items because every additional product feels like it is costing them more than it should. High prices create a psychological ceiling on how much users are willing to spend per visit.

Survey Link: *Do not want to spend more money on this order ranked 4th as a blocker with composite score 2.83 — confirming budget sensitivity is consistent across segments.*

What is the solution?

Zepto should regularly review and adjust the prices of its most frequently purchased products to ensure they remain competitive with local stores and rival platforms. The focus should be on high-visibility items that users compare most often — milk, eggs, bread, snacks, and beverages — and ensuring these are priced fairly.

How this would work in practice:

- Identify the top 50 to 100 most searched and frequently purchased products across all user segments
- Compare Zepto's prices for these products against local store benchmarks and Blinkit, Swiggy Instamart weekly
- Apply targeted price adjustments or price match guarantees on these high-visibility products
- Highlight price drops clearly on the product page with a label such as Best Price or Price Dropped
- For premium or fresh products, communicate quality value — fresh, quality-checked, delivered in 10 minutes — so users feel the price is justified

Who benefits most?

- Students and hostellers who compare every purchase against local prices
- Bachelors and individual users who feel the price difference even on a single item
- Working professionals who might add snacks or beverages if the price feels right

Expected impact on AOV:

When users feel Zepto's prices are fair, they are more likely to add extra items without second-guessing the cost. Even a modest increase from an average of 3 to 5 items per order to 5 to 7 items would result in a meaningful AOV improvement at scale.

Solution 2: Stock Availability Alerts for Repeat Customers

What behavior are we addressing?

Many users — particularly families and working professionals — have experienced placing a regular order only to find one or more of their usual products is out of stock. This forces them to place smaller orders or abandon the cart, and over time they start expecting disappointment.

Why does this behavior happen?

When users cannot rely on Zepto to consistently stock their regular items, they stop trusting the platform for planned or larger orders. Each out-of-stock experience teaches the user to place a more cautious, smaller order the next time — only ordering what they are certain will be available. This learned caution directly suppresses basket size. The user does not lack the intent to buy more — they lack the confidence that what they want will actually be there.

Survey Link: *Product unavailability was identified as one of the top critical blockers — directly causing order abandonment and reducing trust over repeated experiences.*

What is the solution?

Zepto should build a smart stock alert system that tracks each user's frequently ordered products and proactively notifies them when those products are available, when stock is running low, or when a previously out-of-stock item is back.

How this would work in practice:

- The system identifies each user's frequently ordered products based on order history
- When the user opens the app, the homepage shows a personalised section: Your Regulars Are In Stock Today
- If a regular item is running low, the user receives a push notification: Stock Running Low — Order Before It Sells Out
- When a previously out-of-stock favourite comes back, the user gets an alert: Your Favourite Product Is Back In Stock
- Users can opt in to receive weekly restocking reminders on a preferred day and time to build a regular ordering habit

Who benefits most?

- Families who need reliability for weekly grocery planning
- Working professionals who reorder the same set of products regularly
- Homemakers who manage household stock and need to trust that essentials are available

Expected impact on AOV:

When users feel confident their regular products are available, they open the app with the intention of placing a full order rather than a cautious check. This confidence directly increases the number of items added per order and reduces the hesitation that comes from past out-of-stock disappointments.

Solution 3: Daily Deals, Festive Offers, and Weekend Specials

What behavior are we addressing?

A large portion of Zepto users open the app, find what they came for, and check out immediately. They do not browse, explore, or add anything extra because there is no active reason to do so.

Why does this behavior happen?

Without a time-sensitive offer or a contextually relevant deal, users follow the shortest path to checkout. They are not opposed to buying more — they simply have no trigger to do so. The absence of a well-timed offer means there is no moment in the shopping journey where the user stops and thinks: I should pick this up while I am here. Deals create that moment. They shift the user from task mode into opportunity mode, even briefly, and that shift is enough to add items to the cart.

Survey Link: *Extra percentage discounts for higher order value scored the highest among all offer types at 3.52. 39.13% of users said discount banners on the homepage help them discover new products.*

What is the solution?

Zepto should introduce a structured, rotating offer programme that gives users a fresh reason to explore and add more items every time they open the app. Offers should be tied to specific occasions — daily deals, weekend specials, and festive promotions — so users feel that timing matters and they should act now.

How this would work in practice:

- Daily Deals: 5 to 10 products at a discounted price each day, refreshed every 24 hours, spanning different categories with a countdown timer to create urgency

- Weekend Specials: Larger discounts or bundle deals on Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays — for example, buy any 3 snack items and save INR 30 — to encourage bigger orders when users have more time
- Festive Season Offers: Category-specific promotions during Diwali, Holi, Eid, Pongal, and Onam — sweets, dry fruits, gift packs, cleaning products — to tap into increased festive spending
- Tiered Spend Offers: Spend INR 500 and get 5% off, Spend INR 800 and get 10% off — a clear and motivating reason to keep adding items beyond the free delivery minimum
- Personalised Offers: Using order history, Zepto sends personalised deal notifications — a user who always buys noodles gets a deal on noodles paired with a sauce they have never tried

Who benefits most?

- Deal seekers who look for discounts before placing an order
- Students and hostellers motivated by savings and bundle deals
- Families who plan purchases and stock up when a good deal is available
- Working professionals who respond to time-saving bundle deals during busy weekdays

Expected impact on AOV:

Well-timed offers give users a concrete reason to add more items. A user who came to buy bread may add butter because it is on a daily deal. A family may add two extra items to qualify for a bundle discount. Even modest deal-driven additions per order compound into significant AOV growth at platform scale.

Solution 4: Lower the Minimum Order Value for Free Delivery

What behavior are we addressing?

Many users — especially students, bachelors, and occasional shoppers — place small orders and encounter delivery fees that feel disproportionate to the value of their purchase. Instead of adding more items, some simply accept the fee, reduce their order, or abandon the cart entirely.

Why does this behavior happen?

When the free delivery minimum feels too high relative to what a user actually needs, the entire fee structure feels like a penalty for ordering a small amount. A student who needs a packet of noodles and a soft drink totalling INR 120 and sees a INR 25 delivery fee added on top does not

think: I should add more items. They think: this is not worth it. The fee creates a sense of unfairness, not motivation. Users exit feeling that the platform is not designed for them.

Survey Link: *Delivery charges ranked as the #1 blocker with composite score 3.74. 56.52% of users stop adding items once the free delivery minimum is reached — showing the threshold has powerful influence on behavior.*

What is the solution?

Zepto should review and reduce its minimum order value for free delivery to a level that most users can reach naturally with 3 to 5 items. A tiered delivery fee structure should also be introduced so that even small-order users are charged a fair, proportionate fee rather than a flat heavy charge.

How this would work in practice:

- Reduce the free delivery threshold to a level accessible for 3 to 5 item orders — for example, from INR 250 to INR 149 or INR 199
- Introduce a tiered delivery fee: orders below INR 99 attract INR 15, orders between INR 99 and INR 149 attract INR 10, and orders above INR 149 are free
- Show a real-time progress bar in the cart: You are INR 30 away from free delivery — nudging users to add one more item rather than pay the fee
- Offer free delivery on all orders for first-time users or returning users who have been inactive for 30+ days
- For Zepto Pass subscribers, offer a permanently lower or zero delivery threshold as a key membership benefit

Who benefits most?

- Students and hostellers who place small, low-value orders and feel delivery fees most sharply
- Bachelors and individual users who order 1 to 3 items and find the current threshold out of reach
- Occasional users who avoid Zepto because small orders end up costing more than expected

Expected impact on AOV:

Lowering the threshold removes the penalty for small-order users and brings more orders onto the platform. The real-time progress bar then nudges users to add 1 to 2 more items to reach free

delivery. This small, natural nudge — multiplied across millions of daily orders — creates a significant AOV improvement.

Solution 5: Product Quality Checks and Freshness Standards

What behavior are we addressing?

A significant number of users trust Zepto for packaged and branded goods but refuse to order fresh items — vegetables, fruits, dairy, or meat — because of past experiences with poor quality or products close to expiry.

Why does this behavior happen?

With packaged goods, quality is guaranteed by the brand and the sealed packaging — the product is the same regardless of where you buy it. With fresh products, quality is entirely in the hands of whoever picked, packed, and delivered it. Users cannot see, smell, or touch the product before it arrives. This lack of control creates anxiety. One bad experience — a bag of bruised tomatoes, a carton of milk expiring the next day — is enough to permanently remove that category from the user's mental list of things to order on Zepto. Once trust is broken in a category, it is very difficult to rebuild without a clear, visible signal that things have changed.

Survey Link: *17.39% of users never explore new categories on Zepto. Trust restricted to certain categories was identified as one of the top blockers, with users specifically avoiding fresh produce and meat.*

What is the solution?

Zepto should implement clear, visible, and consistent product quality and freshness standards across all fresh categories, communicated to the user at every step — from the product listing to the delivery — so users feel confident ordering items they currently avoid.

How this would work in practice:

- Freshness Guarantee Badge: Every fresh product listing carries a Freshness Guaranteed badge confirming it has passed a quality check before being packed
- Expiry Date Visibility: Show minimum remaining shelf life clearly on the product page — for example, Minimum 3 days freshness guaranteed
- Easy No-Questions-Asked Replacement Policy: Users can report a quality issue in one tap and receive an immediate replacement or refund — making the process fast and rebuilding trust quickly
- Quality Check at Dark Stores: Staff follow a standard freshness checklist before packing fresh items — items that do not meet the standard are not packed, even if it means showing the item as temporarily unavailable

- User Ratings on Fresh Products: Allow users to rate quality after delivery, with ratings shown on the product page — social proof that 200 customers rated the tomatoes 4.5 out of 5 gives new buyers confidence
- First Fresh Order Incentive: For users who have never ordered from a fresh category, show a personalised nudge: Try Our Fresh Vegetables Today — Get INR 20 Off Your First Fresh Order

Who benefits most?

- Families and homemakers who currently buy vegetables and fresh produce from local vendors but would prefer delivery if quality could be trusted
- Working professionals who do not have time to visit a market but hesitate to order fresh items online
- Users aged 35 to 44 — the largest survey segment — who manage household grocery decisions and care deeply about product quality

Expected impact on AOV:

Fresh categories — vegetables, fruits, dairy, and meat — represent some of the highest-volume product types in any grocery basket. A family that currently orders INR 400 in packaged goods and then adds INR 300 in fresh vegetables and dairy to the same order has grown their basket size by 75%. Trust in quality is therefore not just a customer experience improvement — it is a direct and powerful driver of AOV growth.

6. Prioritization Using the RICE Framework

Now that we have identified five solutions, the next step is to decide which ones to build first. In product management, Prioritization is about making the best use of limited time and resources to deliver the highest possible impact. The RICE framework is a simple and widely used method for this.

6.1 What Is the RICE Framework?

RICE stands for four factors that together determine the priority score of a solution:

- R — Reach: How many users will this solution affect within a given time period? Scored on a scale of 1 to 10 where 10 means it affects almost all users.
- I — Impact: How much will this solution move the AOV needle for each user it reaches? Scored as 0.25 (minimal), 0.5 (low), 1 (medium), 2 (high), or 3 (massive).
- C — Confidence: How sure are we that this solution will work as expected, based on our research and survey data? Expressed as a percentage from 0% to 100%.
- E — Effort: How much time and resource does this solution require to build and launch? Scored on a scale of 1 to 10 where 1 is very easy and 10 is extremely complex.

The RICE Score is calculated as follows:

RICE Score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort

A higher RICE score means the solution should be built sooner. It delivers more value to more users with greater confidence and relatively less effort.

6.2 RICE Scores for All Five Solutions

After having discussed, estimated the values for the Reach, Impact, Confidence and Effort, the score values are then computed and results are tabulated as below:

Solution	Reach (R)	Impact (I)	Confidence (C)%	Effort (E)	RICE Score
Lower Minimum Order Value for Free Delivery	9	3	85%	2	1147.5
Daily Deals, Festive and Weekend Offers	8	3	80%	3	640

Stock Availability Alerts for Repeat Orders	7	3	85%	3	595
Price Drops and Competitive Pricing	8	2	75%	4	300
Product Quality and Freshness Standards	6	3	70%	5	252

6.3 Detailed Justification for Each RICE Score

Solution 1: Price Drops and Competitive Pricing — RICE Score: 300

Reach — 8 out of 10:

Pricing affects almost every user on the platform. All segments — from students to families to working professionals — are influenced by product prices. However, the impact is more pronounced for price-sensitive segments like students and bachelors, which is why it scores 8 rather than 10.

Impact — 2 out of 3:

Price adjustments on high-visibility products will encourage users to explore more and add extra items. However, price alone does not resolve the urgency behavior or the out-of-stock trust issues, so the impact on AOV per user is high but not at the maximum level.

Confidence — 75%:

The survey confirms users feel Zepto's prices are sometimes too high and that budget sensitivity influences their behavior. However, the exact price points at which users would change their behavior require further testing. We are reasonably confident but not fully certain.

Effort — 4 out of 10:

Competitive price benchmarking, approvals from category teams, supplier negotiations, and system updates for dynamic pricing require meaningful investment in time and internal coordination. This is not a quick fix.

Priority Verdict:

Medium priority. Important in the long run but requires significant effort and has lower immediate confidence compared to other solutions. Best approached as a phased initiative starting with the top 50 most-compared products.

Solution 2: Stock Availability Alerts for Repeat Customers — RICE Score: 595

Reach — 7 out of 10:

This solution targets users who order regularly — families, working professionals, and homemakers. These are high-value, loyal users who represent a significant portion of Zepto's revenue. The survey confirms product unavailability as a top blocker, validating that this issue is real and widespread among regular users.

Impact — 3 out of 3:

Solving the out-of-stock trust issue has a massive impact on regular users. A user who previously placed a cautious INR 300 order because they were not sure their items would be in stock will place a full INR 800 order confidently once they know availability. This is one of the highest direct AOV levers available.

Confidence — 85%:

Product unavailability was explicitly flagged as a top blocker in the research. The behavior of placing smaller orders due to past stock disappointments is a well-documented pattern. We have very high confidence that solving this will result in larger orders from regular users.

Effort — 3 out of 10:

Building a personalised stock alert system requires integration with inventory management systems and push notification infrastructure. However, Zepto likely already has much of this in place. The effort is moderate — feasible within a standard sprint cycle.

Priority Verdict:

High priority. Targets high-value repeat users, has massive impact on AOV, high confidence from research, and moderate effort. A strong candidate for early implementation.

Solution 3: Daily Deals, Festive Offers, and Weekend Specials — RICE Score: 640

Reach — 8 out of 10:

Deals and offers are relevant to almost all user segments. Deal seekers are the primary beneficiaries, but families, students, and working professionals also respond to well-timed offers. The survey confirmed that discount banners and bundle offers are among the top product discovery channels.

Impact — 3 out of 3:

Time-sensitive offers are one of the most proven mechanisms for increasing cart additions in e-commerce. The survey showed that tiered discounts for higher order values scored the highest average among all offer types at 3.52. A user who adds 2 to 3 extra items per order due to a deal has a directly measurable AOV increase.

Confidence — 80%:

The survey provides strong evidence that users respond to discounts and deals. The confidence is slightly below 85% because the exact deal structure — daily versus weekly, percentage versus fixed — still needs to be tested and optimised for Zepto's specific user base.

Effort — 3 out of 10:

A deals programme requires coordination between product, marketing, and category teams. Deal selection, pricing negotiation with suppliers, and homepage placement all take time. However, Zepto already runs promotions, so this is an extension of existing infrastructure rather than something built from scratch.

Priority Verdict:

High priority. Broad reach, massive impact on AOV, strong survey evidence, and moderate effort. This solution should be in the first wave of implementation alongside stock alerts.

Solution 4: Lower the Minimum Order Value for Free Delivery — RICE Score: 1147.5

Reach — 9 out of 10:

Delivery fees affect virtually every user on the platform — and especially the majority of small-order users identified in the survey. 87% of users place orders of 5 items or fewer, meaning nearly all of them are regularly encountering the delivery fee decision. This is the widest-reaching solution of all five.

Impact — 3 out of 3:

The delivery fee is the single most cited blocker in the entire research — composite score of 3.74, ranked number one by 43.48% of users. Removing or reducing this barrier has a direct and immediate effect on the number of users who place orders and the number of items they add to

reach the threshold. The real-time progress bar (You are INR 30 away from free delivery) is one of the simplest and most effective cart nudges in e-commerce.

Confidence — 85%:

The survey provides the strongest and most direct evidence for this solution of any of the five. Delivery charges ranked number one as a blocker with the highest composite score. We are very confident that reducing this barrier will result in more orders being placed and more items being added per order.

Effort — 2 out of 10:

Changing the free delivery threshold and introducing a tiered fee structure is primarily a policy and configuration change. It does not require building new features from scratch. The progress bar in the cart is a simple UI addition. This is one of the lowest-effort solutions with the highest potential return.

Priority Verdict:

Highest priority. This solution has the widest reach, maximum impact, strongest survey confidence, and the lowest effort of all five solutions. It should be the first solution implemented. The business case is clear, the evidence is strong, and the execution is straightforward.

Solution 5: Product Quality Checks and Freshness Standards — RICE Score: 252

Reach — 6 out of 10:

This solution primarily targets users who would consider ordering fresh categories but currently do not due to trust concerns. Families and homemakers are the core beneficiaries. While this is a significant segment, it is narrower than the reach of delivery fee changes or deals.

Impact — 3 out of 3:

If a family that currently orders INR 400 in packaged goods starts adding INR 300 in fresh vegetables and dairy, the basket size grows by 75%. The potential AOV impact per user is massive — arguably the highest of all five solutions for the users it reaches.

Confidence — 70%:

The research strongly confirms that category trust is a real barrier. However, quality improvement is an operational and supply chain challenge that is harder to guarantee and measure than a pricing or UI change. The confidence that quality standards will be delivered consistently across all dark stores and all fresh categories is lower than for the other solutions.

Effort — 5 out of 10:

This solution requires changes to dark store operations, staff training, supplier quality agreements, app feature development (badges, ratings, replacement policy), and ongoing monitoring. It is the most operationally complex of the five solutions and requires sustained effort over time, not just a one-time build.

Priority Verdict:

Lower priority in the short term due to high effort and moderate confidence, but critical in the medium to long term. Once the higher-priority solutions are live, investment in quality and freshness standards will unlock a new tier of AOV growth that the other solutions cannot reach.

Final Priority Order — Recommended Implementation Sequence

Rank	Solution	RICE Score	Why This Order
1	Lower Minimum Order Value for Free Delivery	1147.5	Widest reach, #1 survey-backed blocker, lowest effort, fastest win
2	Daily Deals, Festive Offers, and Weekend Specials	640	Broad reach, strong survey evidence, proven AOV lever in e-commerce
3	Stock Availability Alerts for Repeat Customers	595	High-value users, massive trust and AOV impact, moderate effort
4	Price Drops and Competitive Pricing	300	Important long-term lever but requires more effort and phased approach
5	Product Quality and Freshness Standards	252	Highest per-user AOV potential but most complex — medium to long term

7. Final Summary

This document has taken a full product management approach to the challenge of increasing Average Order Value (AOV) at Zepto. Here is a concise recap of everything covered, from research to Prioritization.

We conducted a primary survey of 23 Zepto users across 13 questions, combined with secondary research from app reviews, industry data, and competitor analysis. The research gave us both behavioral data — what users do — and motivational insights — why they do it — creating a balanced and complete picture of Zepto's user base.

Zepto users fall into two broad groups. Regular users include families, bachelors, and working professionals who rely on the platform frequently. Occasional users include students, emergency shoppers, and individual buyers. Across all groups, the dominant behavior is urgency-driven, small-item ordering — confirmed by the survey finding that 78.26% of users shop for urgent delivery and 87% place orders of 5 items or fewer.

Twelve key blockers were identified and explained with both what behavior is observed and why it happens. The top blockers — ranked by survey data — are delivery charges on small orders (composite score 3.74), the free delivery threshold acting as a ceiling (56.52% of users stop once it is reached), urgency-driven small orders (78.26% of users), poor product discovery and weak recommendations (56.52% neutral on trust), and limited category trust (17.39% never explore new categories).

Zepto users primarily use the platform to fulfil urgent, immediate needs, resulting in small basket sizes. Several barriers — delivery fees, out-of-stock issues, high prices, category trust gaps, and poor discovery — prevent users from exploring beyond their intended purchase, ultimately limiting AOV growth.

To encourage users to increase their basket size, Zepto can focus on offering fair and competitive pricing, ensuring products are consistently in stock, and providing timely promotions such as daily deals, festive offers, and weekend specials. Reducing the minimum order value required for free delivery can further motivate users to add more items to their cart, while maintaining high product quality and freshness across all categories helps build customer trust and encourages them to purchase a wider range of products from the platform.

Based on the RICE framework, the highest priority is to lower the minimum order value for free delivery, as it offers the greatest reach and impact with relatively low effort. This is followed by introducing daily deals, festive offers, and weekend specials to encourage users to add more items. Stock availability alerts rank third by improving trust among repeat customers. Competitive pricing is a valuable long-term strategy to enhance price perception, while maintaining high product quality and freshness is prioritized last due to its longer implementation timeline, despite its strong potential to increase basket size over time.

Closing Thought

Increasing AOV at Zepto is not about pushing users to spend more than they want to. It is about removing the barriers that currently prevent them from buying what they already need and making the experience rewarding enough that adding one or two more items feels natural, easy, and worthwhile. The five solutions proposed here — implemented in the order recommended by the RICE framework — create exactly that environment.

When users feel that prices are fair, their regular products are reliably in stock, deals are relevant and honest, delivery is accessible for all order sizes, and fresh products can be trusted, they will naturally spend more — not because they were pressured to, but because the platform finally makes it easy and worthwhile.